There is one widely known study provided by the Robert Koch Institute (RKI) and the German Environment Agency about how much microplastic, unable to leave our bodies, we have in our blood, pee, and lungs. From a study on 2,500 children and teenagers, it turned out that 97% of them had some amount of plastic in them. However, the symptoms of long-term exposure are, of course, still unclear, since plastic is widely used for only around 70 years..

From what we can speculate, the effects of long plastic exposure may look like:

- **chronic inflammation**, which may look like: constant lack of energy, trouble sleeping, unexplained muscle pain, acne. You can support your cells by not giving them extra toxins to digest: less sugar, less processed food, less unhealthy fats, and some extra fruits and vegetables of course.

- **oxidative stress**, which means that your cells can't produce enough healthy cells (because cells produce cells) that could fight toxins. This may look like: chronic fatigue, headaches, concentration problems, dry skin, and weakened immunity. You can support your cells by giving them the right fuel, in this case food rich in vitamins A, C, and B: carrots, sweet potatoes, spinach, mango, lemon, kiwi, broccoli, avocado, olives, almonds.

- **the hormonal system**. In this case, a little understanding of **how the hormonal system works** may be helpful: hormones are little fibers that connect to specific receptors in your body. Once the receptor receives a specific hormone, some body activities like, for instance, producing immune cells, lowering blood pressure, or maintaining sugar levels can start. And what micro- and nanoplastics do is clog these receptors, so certain natural reactions can be limited. An unbalanced hormonal system may look like: fertility disorders, chronic fatigue, sudden weight loss or gain, low sex drive, acne, annoying mood swings. You can help your cells produce hormones and unclog receptors by: having lots of good quality sleep, working out, and eating lots of fish (e.g. salmon), eggs, fruit, chia and pumpkin seeds, oysters, spinach.

Secientific consensus about that matter can provide certain changes only after the data is fully confirmed. You don't have to wait. We already have growing evidence on how plastic appearing in your body affects it. You can be ahead of time in that matter :)

Microplastics can also **reach your lungs** through inhalation of plastic particles from:

- plastic and synthetic clothing
- plastic sheets
- any ‘soft’ plastic material, for example, toys

Microplastics and other plastic-associated chemicals can appear **in your blood and urine**, not only from plastic water bottles, but also from:

- food and drinks reheated in plastic
- foods stored in plastic containers for a long time
- brushing your teeth with a plastic toothbrush
- cosmetics that are stored in plastic packaging for a long time
- plastic cutlery

Ideas for reducing your exposure:

main one – having a reusable cup

buying clothes and sheets made of natural materials
(a big amount of good-quality natural clothing and materials that are cheap are considered ‘vintage’, and you can find a great amount of them on the internet or in second-hand shops) – **this idea also has a huge environmental impact and helps decrease support for extremely harmful and Earth-polluting fast fashion. It also supports the idea that unless we discover something amazingly new, we already have enough ‘stuff’.**

having jars, glass plates, bowls, etc. at home, into which you put your food, so it doesn’t stay in plastic packaging for long. For example – rice, pasta, veggies and fruits, milk/juices, etc.

having wooden or metal kitchen utensils

avoiding foods and drinks served hot in plastic

drinking lots of water :))



peace, Aeria Lilith